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Liquid ejection head, liquid ejection apparatus, and ejection module

Abstract

A liquid ejection head that is compact and whose reliability of an electrical connection portion is high includes a plurality of sets of element substrates in which a plurality of ejection elements ejecting a liquid of the same type is arrayed and a plurality of sets of electrical wiring members for supplying electric power to the element substrates. Each element substrate is arrayed in a second direction inclined with respect to a first direction in which the plurality of ejection elements is arrayed. Each electrical wiring member is connected to a terminal arranged at one end portion of the corresponding element substrate and extends in a third direction intersecting the first direction and the second direction.

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2005/0162468	12/2004	Silverbrook	347/42	B41J 11/057

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Background/Summary

BACKGROUND

Field of the Disclosure

(1) The present disclosure relates to a liquid ejection head, a liquid ejection apparatus, and an ejection module.

Description of the Related Art

(2) Generally, there is a demand for the manufacturing cost of a liquid ejection head to be reduced. In order to reduce the manufacturing cost of a liquid ejection head, an attempt has been made to downsize a liquid ejection head by downsizing the element substrate. On the other hand, in a case where downsizing of the element substrate advances further, the adhesion surface area between the element substrate and a flow path member that supplies a liquid to the element substrate is reduced, and therefore, the reliability of adhesion is reduced.

(3) In order to secure the reliability of adhesion, a print head assembly (that is, liquid ejection head) according to the specification of U.S. Patent Application Publication No. 2005/0162468 secures the adhesion surface area by arranging rectangular print chips (that is, “element substrate”) in-line.

(4) However, in the print head assembly according to the specification of U.S. Patent Application Publication No. 2005/0162468, a plurality of types of liquid are ejected by using one print chip, and therefore, there is a possibility that nonuniformity occurs. Further, the print chip and the printed circuit board according to the specification of U.S. Patent Application Publication No. 2005/0162468 are electrically connected by a TAB film connected almost across the entire area of the long side in the print chip. Due to this, in order to seal the electrical connection portion, a sealing area for sealing the entire area of the long side in the print chip is necessary, and therefore, it is made difficult to downsize the element substrate.

(5) Consequently, an object of the present disclosure is to provide a liquid ejection head that is compact and whose reliability of the electrical connection portion is high.

SUMMARY

(6) In order to achieve the above-described object, the liquid ejection head according to the present disclosure is a liquid ejection head having a plurality of sets of element substrates in which a plurality of ejection elements ejecting a liquid of the same type is arrayed and a plurality of sets of electrical wiring members for supplying electric power to the element substrate, wherein each of the element substrates is arrayed in a second direction inclined with respect to a first direction in which the plurality of ejection elements is arrayed and the electrical wiring member is connected to a terminal arranged at one end portion of the element substrate and extends in a third direction intersecting the first direction and the second direction.

(7) Further features of the present disclosure will become apparent from the following description of exemplary embodiments with reference to the attached drawings.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1A and FIG. 1B are each an outline configuration diagram of a liquid ejection apparatus in one embodiment;

(2) FIG. 2 is a perspective diagram schematically showing one example of a liquid ejection head in one embodiment;

(3) FIG. 3 is a schematic top diagram of the liquid ejection head in one embodiment;

(4) FIG. 4 is a diagram explaining an effect of reliability of electrical connection between an element substrate and an electrical wiring member in one embodiment,

(5) FIG. 5 is a diagram explaining an effect of reliability of electrical connection between an element substrate and an electrical wiring member in one comparative example;

(6) FIG. 6 is a diagram explaining an effect of reliability of electrical connection between an element substrate and an electrical wiring member in one comparative example;

(7) FIG. 7 is a diagram explaining an effect of a liquid ejection head suppressing nonuniformity in one embodiment;

(8) FIG. 8 is a diagram explaining an effect of nonuniformity suppression in one comparative example;

(9) FIG. 9 is a diagram explaining an effect of nonuniformity suppression in one comparative example;

(10) FIG. 10 is a diagram for explaining an application example of one embodiment;

(11) FIG. 11 is a diagram for explaining one comparative example;

(12) FIG. 12 is a perspective diagram schematically showing a cross section of a liquid ejection head in one embodiment;

(13) FIG. 13 is a cross-sectional diagram along a XIII-XIII line in FIG. 12;

(14) FIG. 14 is a diagram for explaining one comparative example;

(15) FIG. 15 is a perspective diagram schematically showing one example of a liquid ejection head in one embodiment;

(16) FIG. 16 is a schematic top diagram of the liquid ejection head in one embodiment; and

(17) FIG. 17 is a perspective diagram schematically showing a cross section of the liquid ejection head in one embodiment.

DESCRIPTION OF THE EMBODIMENTS

(18) It is possible to apply a liquid ejection head, a liquid ejection apparatus, and a liquid supply method of the present disclosure to a device, such as a printer, a copy machine, a facsimile machine having a communication system, and a word processor having a printer unit, and further, to an industrial printing apparatus combined compositely with various processing devices. For example, it is also possible to use them for the purpose of biochip manufacturing, electronic circuit printing and the like.

(19) Further, embodiments to be described in the following are appropriate specific examples of the present disclosure, and therefore, a variety of technically preferable restrictions are imposed thereon. However, as long as the concept of the present disclosure is observed, the present embodiments are not limited to the embodiments of the present specification and other specific methods.

First Embodiment

(20) <Liquid Ejection Apparatus **10**>

(21) FIG. **1** is an outline configuration diagram of a liquid ejection apparatus **10** in the present embodiment.

(22) In the present embodiment, the longitudinal direction of a printing unit **12** is taken to be a $\pm X$ -direction. Further, the short-side direction of the printing unit **12** is taken to be a $\pm Y$ -direction. A printing medium **P** is conveyed in the $+Y$ -direction, and therefore, the $+Y$ -direction is appropriately called “conveyance direction”. Further, the direction of gravity (downward direction) is taken to be a $+Z$ -direction and the direction (upward direction) opposite to the direction of gravity is taken to be a $-Z$ -direction.

(23) As shown in FIG. **1A**, the liquid ejection apparatus **10** comprises a conveyance unit **11** and the printing unit **12**. The conveyance unit **11** conveys the sheet-shaped printing medium **P** in a predetermined direction (in the present embodiment, the $+Y$ -direction). Due to this, the printing medium **P** passes under the printing unit **12** (on the side in the $+Z$ -direction) in the predetermined direction at a predetermined speed. The printing unit **12** mainly includes a liquid ejection head **100**, to be described later. Further, the liquid ejection head **100** includes a plurality of ejection modules. The ejection module includes an element substrate having an ejection element column in which a plurality of ejection elements ejecting a liquid of the same type is arrayed and an electrical connection portion arranged at the end portion in the direction of the array with respect to the ejection element column. Further, the ejection module includes an electrical connection member electrically connecting to an electrical connection portion and extending in the direction intersecting the direction of the array of the ejection element column. Here, the “ejection element” is called including an ejection port in the ejection element column and an energy generation element for ejecting a liquid from the ejection port by receiving electric energy that is sent via the electrical connection member.

(24) The liquid ejection head **100** comprises a plurality of ejection ports **201** (see FIG. **3**) ejecting a liquid (for example, ink including color material) as droplets. The plurality of the ejection ports **201** is arrayed in a range corresponding to the width (length in the X -direction) of the printing medium **P** along the direction (the X -direction) intersecting (in the present embodiment, perpendicular to) the conveyance direction (the $+Y$ -direction) of the printing medium **P**. At the time of the printing medium **P** passing under the liquid ejection head **100**, the ejection element provided corresponding to each ejection port of the liquid ejection head **100** is driven in accordance with ejection data. Due to this, the liquid is ejected in the $+Z$ -direction toward the printing medium **P** from the ejection port **201** and an image is printed. As described above, the liquid ejection apparatus **10** in the present embodiment is a full-line type printing apparatus performing printing by ejecting a liquid from an ejection element column **202** (see FIG. **3**) arrayed along the width direction (the X -direction) of the printing medium **P** while conveying the printing medium **P** continuously or intermittently.

(25) FIG. **1B** is a block diagram showing the control configuration of the liquid ejection apparatus **10** in the present embodiment. The liquid ejection apparatus **10** comprises a CPU **20**, a ROM **21**, and a RAM **22**. The CPU **20** comprehensively controls each unit of the liquid ejection apparatus **10** while using the RAM **22** as a work area in accordance with programs stored in the ROM **21**. For example, the CPU **20** generates ejection data for driving the ejection element of the liquid ejection head **100** by performing predetermined image processing in accordance with programs and parameters stored in the ROM **21** for the image data received from a host apparatus **30** connected externally. The CPU **20** drives the liquid ejection head **100** in accordance with ejection data and

causes a liquid to be ejected at a predetermined frequency. Further, the CPU **20** drives a conveyance motor **23** and causes the conveyance unit **11** to convey the printing medium P in the +Y-direction at a speed corresponding to the ejection frequency of the ejection operation by the liquid ejection head **100**. Due to this, on the printing medium P, an image in accordance with image data received from the host apparatus **30** is printed.

(26) Further, a liquid sending unit **24** is a unit for supplying a liquid to the liquid ejection head **100**. The liquid sending unit **24** controls a pressure control unit, a switch mechanism and the like provided internally and controls the flow of the liquid in the flow path of the liquid including the liquid ejection head **100** under the management of the CPU **20**. The liquid sending unit **24** may be a unit configured to function as a liquid supply unit configured to supply a liquid to the liquid ejection head **100** or may be a unit having a function as a liquid circulation unit configured to circulate a liquid in the circulation path including the liquid ejection head **100**.

(27) <Explanation of Liquid Ejection Head **100**>

(28) FIG. **2** is a perspective diagram schematically showing one example of the liquid ejection head **100** in the present embodiment.

(29) As shown in FIG. **2**, the liquid ejection head **100** in the present embodiment comprises a first flow path member **101**, a second flow path member **102**, an element substrate **104**, and an electrical wiring member **105**. The liquid ejection head **100** is configured by laminating the first flow path member **101** and the second flow path member **102** to which the element substrate **104** to which the electrical wiring member **105** is connected electrically is attached. The first flow path member **101** and the second flow path member **102** are each a member that distributes the liquid supplied from the liquid sending unit **24** (see FIG. **1B**) of the liquid ejection apparatus **10** to each element substrate **104**. That is, the liquid ejection head **100** has a flow path portion in which a supply flow path that supplies a liquid to the element substrate **104** is formed.

(30) Inside the first flow path member **101**, a flow path extending in the X-direction and a flow path that communicates with the second flow path member **102** are formed in the state where the second flow path member **102** is laminated on the first flow path member **101**. In the second flow path member **102**, a flow path that communicates with the first flow path member **101** is formed in the state where the second flow path member **102** is laminated on the first flow path member **101**. Further, in the second flow path member **102**, a flow path that communicates with the second flow path member **102** is formed in the state where the element substrate **104** is attached to the second flow path member **102**. Inside the first flow path member **101**, a flow path extending in the X-direction is formed. By the first flow path member **101**, the second flow path member **102**, and the element substrate **104** being laminated in this order, a flow path that communicates with each individual printing element of the element substrate **104** from the flow path of the first flow path member **101** is formed.

(31) On the top surface of the second flow path member **102**, the 15 element substrates **104** are arrayed approximately linearly (arranged in-line) in the direction intersecting the conveyance direction. In the present embodiment, the electrical wiring member **105** electrically connected with the element substrate **104** extends toward the short-side direction (here, the -Y-direction) of the liquid ejection head **100** up to the outside of the long side of the liquid ejection head **100**. As one example of the electrical wiring member **105**, there is a flexible wiring substrate. For example, by designing a configuration in which the four liquid ejection heads **100** configured as described above are used and each liquid ejection head **100** ejects ink whose color is different from one another, it is possible to eject inks of four colors of YMCK (yellow, magenta, cyan, black).

(32) FIG. **3** is a schematic top diagram of the liquid ejection head **100** in the present embodiment.

(33) As shown in FIG. **3**, the liquid ejection head **100** has a plurality of the element substrates **104** in which a plurality of ejection elements ejecting the same type of ink is arranged and a plurality of the electrical wiring members **105** for supplying electric power to each of the plurality of the element substrates.

(34) The plurality of the element substrates **104** is arrayed along a predetermined direction (for example, the X-direction in FIG. **3**) inclined with respect to the array direction in which the plurality of the ejection elements is arrayed. Each of the plurality of the electrical wiring members **105** is arranged at the end portion in the direction in which the plurality of the ejection elements of the element substrate **104** is arrayed and extends in the same direction (for example, the -Y-direction in FIG. **3**) intersecting a predetermined direction from each of the plurality of the element substrates **104**. In the present embodiment, the shape of the element substrate **104** is an approximate rectangle. The shape of the element substrate **104** may be an approximate parallelogram. However, in view of the substrate cutting process included in the manufacturing process of the element substrate **104**, it is preferable for the shape of the element substrate **104** to be an approximate rectangle rather than an approximate parallelogram. On the top surface of the element substrate **104**, the ejection port **201** ejecting a liquid is formed. In the following, the surface on the side on which the ejection port **201** of the element substrate **104** is formed is called "ejection surface" appropriately. The ejection element column **202** in which the plurality of the ejection ports **201** is arrayed is arranged to as to be inclined a predetermined angle with respect to the longitudinal direction (that is, the X-direction) of the liquid ejection head **100**. In the following, the direction in which the ejection elements are arrayed is called "array direction".

(35) Further, the plurality of the element substrates **104** is arrayed so as to have an area in which the two adjacent element substrates **104** overlap in a case where they are viewed from a predetermined direction toward the intersecting direction (for example, on the side in the Y-direction). For example, the ejection port **201** of the one element substrate **104** of the two adjacent element substrates **104** and the ejection port **201** of the other element substrate **104** adjacent to the former element substrate **104** are arrayed so as to overlap on the same axis line in the direction (the Y-direction) intersecting the array direction.

(36) In the following, an area in the array direction is called "link portion" in which the ejection element columns of the two adjacent element substrates among the plurality of the element substrates overlap each other on the same axis line in the direction (for example, the Y-direction) intersecting the direction of the ejection element column. On the other hand, an area in the X-direction is called "non-link portion" in which the ejection element columns of the two adjacent element substrates do not overlap each other on the same axis line in the Y-direction.

(37) Further, on the side further closer to the front edge in the array direction (on the side in the +X-direction), an electrical connection portion **204** is provided. That is, the electrical connection portion **204** is provided on the side further closer to the front edge in the array direction than the ejection port arranged at the end portion in the array direction in which the plurality of ejection ports is arrayed. At the electrical connection portion **204**, a plurality of terminals is arranged along the array direction. Each terminal is electrically connected with the main body of the liquid ejection apparatus **10** via the electrical wiring member **105**. Each terminal may be arrayed along the X-direction as long as the terminal can connect with the electrical wiring member **105** electrically. The electrical wiring member **105** electrically connects with the electrical connection portion **204** of each element substrate **104** and extends in the direction intersecting the array direction. Each element substrate **104** is connected electrically with an electrical wiring substrate (not shown schematically) included in the printing unit **12** via the electrical wiring member **105**.

(38) FIG. **4** is a diagram explaining the effect of reliability of the electrical connection between the element substrate **104** and the electrical wiring member **105** in the present embodiment.

(39) As shown in FIG. **4**, each electrical wiring member **105** extends from the terminal arranged at each electrical connection portion **204** provided on the ejection surface of each element substrate **104** to the outside of the long side of the liquid ejection head **100** toward the short-side direction (in the example shown in FIG. **4**, the -Y-direction) of the liquid ejection head **100**.

(40) Here, in order to implement electrical connection of high reliability, it is preferable to arrange the electrical connection portion **204** at a position distant to a certain extent from the ejection

element column **202** in the array direction of the ejection elements for the purpose of preventing electrical interference. According to the configuration such as this, even in a case where a distance **301** from the ejection element column **202** to the electrical connection portion of the element substrate **104** and the electrical wiring member **105** increases, it is possible to reduce the influence that is exerted on the area of the element substrate **104** compared to that in a comparative example, to be described later.

Comparative Example

(41) In the following, in order to make easy understanding of the electrical connection in the present embodiment, explanation is given by showing two comparative examples in which the conditions necessary for the present disclosure are not satisfied. Explanation of the configuration the same as or corresponding to the configuration in the present embodiment is omitted appropriately and different points are explained mainly.

(42) FIG. 5 is a diagram showing an example in which the electrical connection portion is not arranged at the end portion in the array direction.

(43) As shown in FIG. 5, the present comparative example differs from the present embodiment in that the shape of an element substrate **401** is an approximate parallelogram. In the present comparative example, by arranging the element substrate **401** whose shape is an approximate parallelogram in the X-direction, the array direction is inclined with respect to the X-direction.

(44) Further, the comparative example differs from the present embodiment also in that an electrical connection portion **402** is provided substantially at the center in the longitudinal direction of the element substrate **401**. Consequently, an electrical wiring member **403** is also attached substantially to the center in the longitudinal direction of the element substrate **401**.

(45) In the configuration such as this, in a case where an attempt is made to secure a distance **405** from an ejection element column **404** to the electrical connection portion **402**, it is necessary to increase the length of the element substrate **401** in the short-side direction (the Y-direction). That is, the area of the element substrate **401** in the comparative example becomes larger than the area of the element substrate **104** (see FIG. 4) in the present embodiment. Consequently, with the configuration of the present comparative example, it becomes difficult to achieve both downsizing of the element substrate and reliability of the electrical connection compared to the present embodiment.

(46) FIG. 6 is a diagram showing an example in which the element substrate is arranged without inclining the element substrate in the array direction.

(47) As shown in FIG. 6, this example differs from the present embodiment in that each ejection port is arrayed without being inclined with respect to the longitudinal direction of each element substrate **501**. In a case where an electrical wiring member **502** is extended in the direction intersecting the array direction in the state where each ejection port is arrayed without being inclined with respect to the longitudinal direction of each element substrate **501**, it is necessary to arrange each element substrate **501** in a staggered pattern in order to secure an area in which a link portion is provided. In a case where each element substrate **501** is arranged in a staggered pattern, on a condition that an attempt is made to extend all the electrical wiring members **502** in the same direction (for example, the -Y-direction), the electrical wiring member of the one element substrate of the two adjacent element substrates interferes with the other element substrate. For example, in a case where the orientation of the second element substrate from the left in FIG. 6 is reversed, the electrical wiring member **502** of the second element substrate physically hits the third element substrate from the left in FIG. 6.

(48) In order to avoid such a situation, it is necessary to arrange each element substrate **501** so that the electrical wiring member **502** of each element substrate **501** extends alternately in the opposite directions (the +Y-direction and the -Y-direction). In this case, it is necessary to further install an electrical wiring substrate (not shown schematically) that electrically connects with the electrical wiring member **502** also on the side in the +Y-direction, in addition to the side in the -Y-direction,

and therefore, the manufacturing cost will increase. The above is the explanation of the electrical connection in the comparative example. In the following, explanation is returned to the present embodiment.

(49) <Suppression Effect of Nonuniformity>

(50) FIG. 7 is a diagram explaining the effect by the liquid ejection head in the present embodiment suppressing nonuniformity. Here, for convenience of explanation, explanation is given in the state where the electrical wiring member is removed from the element substrate. Further, explanation is given by calling the liquid ejection head that ejects the magenta ink of the plurality of the liquid ejection heads **100** shown in FIG. 2 a first liquid ejection head **100m** and the liquid ejection head that ejects the cyan ink a second liquid ejection head **100c**. Then, explanation is given by calling an element substrate adjacent to a first element substrate **611** of the first liquid ejection head **100m** a second element substrate **612**. Explanation is given by calling an element substrate adjacent to a third element substrate **613** of the second element substrate **100c** a fourth element substrate **614**.

(51) Further, as described above, also in FIG. 7, the ejection element columns on the two adjacent element substrates are configured so that at least one ejection port overlaps another in the conveyance direction (the Y-direction) of a printing medium. For example, “area **601**” and “area **602**” shown schematically are each “non-link portion” and “area **603**” is “link portion”.

(52) Further in FIG. 7, “D1” indicates a distance between two ejection element columns in “non-link portion”, which eject different color inks. For example, the distance in the conveyance direction from the ejection element column of the first element substrate **611** in the area **601**, which is “non-link portion”, to the ejection element column of the third element substrate **613** is “D1”. Similarly, the distance in the conveyance direction from the ejection element column of the second element substrate **612** in the area **602**, which is “non-link area”, to the ejection element column of the fourth element substrate **614** is also “D1”.

(53) On the other hand, “D2” indicates the longest distance between the two ejection element columns in “link portion”, which eject different color inks. For example, the distance in the conveyance direction from the ejection element column of the second element substrate **612** in the area **603**, which is “link portion”, to the ejection element column of the third element substrate **613** is “D2”. Then, the distance in the conveyance direction between the two adjacent ejection element columns in “link portion”, which eject the same color ink, is “ΔD”. For example, the distance in the conveyance direction from the ejection element column of the third adjacent element substrate **613** to the ejection element column of the fourth element substrate **614** in “link portion” **603** is “ΔD”, both ejecting the cyan ink.

(54) As shown in FIG. 7, the plurality of the element substrates **104** is configured including an area in which the ejection element columns on the two adjacent element substrates **104** overlap each other in the direction (for example, the Y-direction in FIG. 7) intersecting a predetermined direction (for example, the X-direction in FIG. 7).

(55) Specifically, the first liquid ejection head **100m** and the second liquid ejection head **100c** are arranged in the conveyance direction (that is, the Y-direction). The first element substrate **611** and the second element substrate **612** of the first liquid ejection head **100m** are arranged so as to be inclined a predetermined angle with respect to the longitudinal direction (that is, the X-direction) of the first liquid ejection head **100m**. Similarly, the third element substrate **613** and the fourth element substrate **614** of the second liquid ejection head **100c** are arranged so as to be inclined a predetermined angle with respect to the longitudinal direction (that is, the X-direction) of the second liquid ejection head **100c**.

(56) Generally, there is a trend for the distance between “non-link portions” (that is, the distance “D1”) of the two liquid ejection heads ejecting inks whose colors are different from each other to become large. On the other hand, in “non-link portion”, there is a trend for the distance from the ejection element column of the element substrate to the ejection element column of the element substrate adjacent to the former element substrate (that is, the distance “ΔD”) to become small

compared to the distance between “non-link portions” (that is, the distance “D1”).

(57) Consequently, in the present embodiment, two formulas below hold.

$\Delta D < D1$ formula (1)

$D2 = D1 + \Delta D$ formula (2)

(58) Here, by taking into consideration “formula (1)” and “formula (2)”, it is possible to express the distance in the conveyance direction between the ejection element columns ejecting inks whose colors are different from each other (that is, “D2”) in “link portion” by using a formula below.

$D2 \approx D1$ formula (3)

(59) That is, both in “link portion” and in “non-link portion”, the distances between the two ejection element columns ejecting inks whose colors are different from each other (corresponding to D2 and D1, respectively) are substantially equal. That is, the time from the provision of the cyan ink to the provision of the magenta ink to the printing medium that is conveyed at a constant speed in the +Y-direction is not largely different between “link portion” and “non-link portion”.

(60) Consequently, according to the liquid ejection head in the present embodiment, the nonuniformity due to the time difference is not conspicuous in a case where secondary color inks are ejected in “non-link portion” and “link portion”. As described above, according to the technique of the present disclosure, it is possible to provide a liquid ejection head in which the element substrate has been downsized in the state where the occurrence of nonuniformity is suppressed.

Comparative Example

(61) In the following, in order to explain the effect of nonuniformity suppression in the present embodiment, explanation is given by showing two comparative examples. Explanation of the configuration the same as or corresponding to the configuration in the present embodiment is omitted appropriately and different points are explained mainly.

(62) FIG. 8 is a diagram explaining the effect of nonuniformity suppression in a third comparative example.

(63) As shown in FIG. 8, the third comparative example differs from the present embodiment in that the shape of an element substrate 701 is an approximate parallelogram and ejection element columns corresponding to two colors are arranged on one element substrate. Further, the third comparative example differs from the present embodiment in that the one element substrate 701 comprises an ejection element column 721 and an ejection element column 722 and each ejection element column ejects an ink whose color is different from each other. In the present comparative example, the distance (distance indicated by “D1” in FIG. 8) between the ejection element columns in “non-link portion” (area 711 and area 712) and the distance (distance indicated by “D2” in FIG. 8) between the ejection element columns in “link portion” (area 713) are different. That is, the difference between D1 and D2 is not small and the distance between the ejection element columns ejecting inks whose colors are different is not equal in “non-link portion” and “link portion”. That is, the time difference from the provision of ink by the ejection element column 722 to the provision of ink by the ejection element column 721 to the printing medium that is conveyed at a constant speed in the +Y-direction is different between “link portion” and “non-link portion”. Consequently, with the configuration of the present comparative example, the nonuniformity due to the time difference of the secondary colors becomes conspicuous in “non-link portion” and “link portion”. For example, it is assumed that the magenta ink is ejected from the ejection element column 721 and following this, the cyan ink is ejected from the ejection element column 722 in this order. In this case, at the time of the ink landing onto the printing medium, the permeation speed to printing medium is different between the colors, and therefore, there is a possibility that beading occurs and nonuniformity is caused.

(64) FIG. 9 is a diagram explaining the effect of nonuniformity suppression in a fourth comparative example.

(65) As shown in FIG. 9, the present comparative example differs from the present embodiment in that two element substrates ejecting inks whose colors are different from each other are arranged in

a staggered manner as one set of element substrate group. For example, it is assumed that the cyan ink is ejected from a fifth element substrate **801** and the magenta ink is ejected from a sixth element substrate **802**. In the configuration such as in the present comparative example also, the distance between the ejection element columns ejecting inks whose colors are different from each other in “non-link portion” and the distance between the ejection element columns ejecting inks whose colors are different from each other in “link portion” are no longer equal. That is, the distance “D1” between the ejection element columns ejecting inks whose colors are different from each other in an area **811** and an area **812** and the distance “D2” between the ejection element columns ejecting inks whose colors are different from each other in an area **813** are no longer equal.

(66) Consequently, according to the configuration such as in the present comparative example, the nonuniformity due to the time difference in a case where the secondary color inks are ejected becomes conspicuous in “non-link portion” and “link portion”.

(67) <Conclusion>

(68) As explained above, by arranging the ejection element columns so that the distance from the ejection element column ejecting a liquid to the ejection element column ejecting a liquid whose color is different from that of the former ejection element column is equal in “link portion” and “non-link portion”, it is possible to suppress nonuniformity due to the time difference in a case where a liquid is ejected.

(69) In the present embodiment, explanation is given by taking magenta and cyan as an example of ink colors. For example, in a case where inks whose number of colors is more (generally, four colors of YMCK and more) are used, there is a possibility that the influence of nonuniformity due to the time difference in a case where a liquid is ejected becomes more conspicuous. Because of this, the configuration such as in the present embodiment becomes more effective.

(70) Further, as described above, by arranging each electrical wiring member **105** on the side further closer to the front edge in the array direction and extending the electrical wiring member **105** to the outside of the long side of the liquid ejection head **100** in the same direction, it is also possible to achieve both downsizing of the element substrate **104** and reliability of the electrical connection.

(71) Consequently, according to the technique of the present disclosure, it is possible to provide a liquid ejection head that is compact and whose reliability is high.

(72) Application Example

(73) Generally, in a case of a line head implementing a desired print width by arranging an element substrate inclined with respect to the conveyance direction, it is desirable for the distance in the conveyance direction in “link portion” from an ejection element column to another ejection element column ejecting ink whose color is different from that of the former ejection element column to be small. The reason is that the smaller the distance in the conveyance direction in “link portion” from the ejection element column to another ejection element column ejecting ink whose color is different from that of the former ejection element column, the more it is possible to suppress the occurrence of an air flow. In the following, a relationship between the distance in the link portion and the inclination of the element substrate is explained by using FIG. **10** and FIG. **11**.

(74) <Relationship Between Distance Between Two Adjacent Element Substrates and Inclination>

(75) FIG. **10** is a diagram for explaining an application example of the present embodiment.

(76) As shown in FIG. **10**, in a case where a plurality of the element substrates **104** ejecting the same color ink is arranged in-line in close proximity to one another, the air flow that flows in accompanying the conveyance of a printing medium is blocked by the air flow accompanying the ejection of ink from each ejection port **201**. Because of this, the smaller the distance between the ejection element columns on the two adjacent element substrates **104** in “link portion”, the more unlikely the air flow accompanying the conveyance of a printing medium flows in. That is, the shorter a distance **901** shown in FIG. **10**, the more the air flow accompanying the conveyance of a printing medium is suppressed. As a result of that, in “link portion” in this case, the amount of the

air flow accompanying the conveyance of a printing medium becomes small, and therefore, the position error of a liquid droplet ejected from each ejection port **201** is also suppressed.

(77) In the following, for convenience of explanation, explanation is given by calling an element substrate on the left side in FIG. **10** among three element substrates shown in FIG. **10** a first element substrate and an element substrate at the center in FIG. **10** adjacent to the first element substrate a second element substrate. For example, it is preferable for the distance in a direction perpendicular to a predetermined direction between a first ejection element on the first element substrate and a second ejection element on the second element substrate, which is arranged at the same position as that of the first ejection element in the predetermined direction, to be 2.6 mm or less. That is, it is preferable for the distance in the Y-direction perpendicular to the X-direction between the first ejection element on the first element substrate and the second ejection element on the second element substrate, which is arranged at the same position as that of the first ejection element in the X-direction, to be 2.6 mm or less. According to the configuration such as this, it is possible to suppress the occurrence of the air flow due to the conveyance of a printing medium.

Comparative Example

(78) In the following, in order to explain a relationship between the distance between two adjacent element substrates and the inclination in the present embodiment, explanation is given by showing a comparative example. Explanation of the configuration the same as or corresponding to the configuration in the present embodiment is omitted appropriately and different points are explained mainly.

(79) FIG. **11** is a diagram for explaining a fifth comparative example.

(80) As shown in FIG. **11**, in the present comparative example, a plurality of element substrates **1001** is arranged more inclined (so that the inclination angle becomes closer to 90 degrees) than in the case of the application example shown in FIG. **10**. Further, the distance between the two adjacent element substrates **1001** is longer than that in the application example shown in FIG. **10**. Due to this, in the present comparative example, the distance (distance **1105** shown in FIG. **11**) from an ejection element column **1003** of the element substrate **1001** to the ejection element column **1003** of the element substrate **1001** adjacent to the former element substrate **1001** is longer than that in the application example in FIG. **10**. Then, between the two adjacent ejection element columns, the air flow due to the conveyance of a printing medium becomes more likely to occur. As a result of that, the amount of the air flow that flows in between the two adjacent ejection element columns in “link portion” becomes larger than that in the application example in FIG. **10**, and therefore, the degree of the position error of a liquid droplet ejected from the ejection port also increases. Consequently, in order to suppress the position error of a liquid droplet due to the air flow having flowed into “link portion”, it is important to make the two adjacent ejection element columns closer to each other in “link portion”.

(81) Here, explanation of the application example of the present embodiment is continued by returning to FIG. **10**. In order to make the plurality of the ejection element columns **202** ejecting the same color ink closer to one another as shown in FIG. **10**, it is recommended to reduce the angle at which the element substrate **104** is arranged (so that the angle becomes closer to 0 degrees).

(82) As described above, the plurality of the element substrates **104** is arrayed along a predetermined direction (for example, the X-direction in FIG. **10**) inclined with respect to the array direction in which the plurality of ejection elements is arrayed. As one example, in a case where the print width (that is, the length in the longitudinal direction of the element substrate **104**) is 0.85 in., which is the general length, the predetermined direction (the X-direction in FIG. **10**) is inclined about 7 degrees with respect to the array direction. That is, the element substrate **104** is arranged inclined about 7 degrees with respect to the X-direction in FIG. **10**. As described above, by arranging the plurality of the element substrates **104** inclined, it is possible to make the plurality of the ejection element columns **202** ejecting the same color ink closer to one another.

(83) Further, in that case, in order to suppress the two adjacent element substrates **104** from interfering with each other, it is recommended to reduce the length in the direction intersecting the array direction of the element substrate **104**. For example, it is recommended to design a configuration so that the length in the direction intersecting the array direction of the element substrate **104** is 1.5 mm or less. More specifically, in a case where the shape of the element substrate **104** is an approximate rectangle, it is preferable for a configuration to be designed so that the length of the short side of the element substrate **104** is 1.5 mm or less. That is, it is preferable for a configuration to be designed so that a width **w1** of the element substrate **104** is less than a width **w2** (see FIG. **11**) of the element substrate **1001**.

(84) Further, by downsizing the element substrate **104**, it is also possible to reduce the manufacturing cost of the element substrate **104**, in addition to the suppression of the occurrence of the air flow due to the conveyance of a printing medium. The larger the distance (the distance **901** in FIG. **10**) from the ejection element column **202** of the element substrate **104** to the ejection element column **202** of the element substrate **104** adjacent to the former element substrate **104**, the larger the inclination of the element substrate **104** is. Consequently, the larger the distance from the ejection element column **202** of the element substrate **104** to the ejection element column **202** of the element substrate **104** adjacent to the former element substrate **104**, the more the length of the element substrate **104** for an effective print length **902** increases. That is, the manufacturing cost of the element substrate **104** increases by an amount corresponding to the increase in the length of the element substrate **104**.

(85) Further, also from the viewpoint of downsizing the element substrate **104**, it is preferable for the distance from the ejection element column **202** of the element substrate **104** to the ejection element column **202** of the element substrate **104** adjacent to the former element substrate **104** to be small. In addition, it is important to arrange the ejection element columns highly densely or to increase the number layers of wiring in order to downsize the circuit area occupying the element substrate **104**.

(86) According to the technique of the present disclosure, it is possible to provide an element substrate that is compact and whose reliability of the electrical connection portion is high. Then, it is possible to provide a liquid ejection head that is compact and whose nonuniformity has been suppressed. That is, according to the technique of the present disclosure, it is possible to provide an element substrate and a liquid ejection head that are compact and whose reliability is high.

Second Embodiment

(87) In the present embodiment, a liquid ejection head having a function to circulate a one-color liquid is explained. In the following, explanation of the configuration the same as or corresponding to the configuration of the first embodiment is omitted by using the same name and the same symbol and different points are explained mainly.

(88) FIG. **12** is a perspective diagram schematically showing a cross section of a third liquid ejection head **1100** in a second embodiment.

(89) As shown in FIG. **12**, in the first flow path member **101** in the third liquid ejection head **1100**, a supply flow path **1101** through which the liquid flows in a case where the liquid is ejected and a collection flow path **1102** through which the liquid that has not been ejected flows in a case where the liquid is collected are formed. That is, in the flow path portion in the present embodiment, the collection flow path that collects a liquid that has not been ejected from the ejection element is formed.

(90) FIG. **13** is a cross-sectional diagram along a XIII-XIII line in FIG. **12**.

(91) As shown in FIG. **13**, the third liquid ejection head **1100** in the present embodiment comprises a first connection flow path **1201** that causes the supply flow path **1101** and the element substrate **104** to communicate with each other in the state where the first flow path member **101** and the second flow path member **102** are laminated. Similarly, the third liquid ejection head **1100** comprises a second connection flow path **1202** that causes the element substrate **104** and the

collection flow path **1102** to communicate with each other.

(92) In a case where the ejection operation of a liquid is performed, the liquid flows through the supply flow path **1101** and the first connection flow path **1201** in this order and is ejected from the ejection port **201** of the element substrate **104**. However, there is a case where the entire liquid supplied to the element substrate **104** is not ejected from the ejection port **201**. The liquid that is not ejected from the ejection port **201** flows to the collection flow path **1102** via the second connection flow path **1202**. For example, by this flow, it is possible to collect the thickened ink, the air bubble and the like that occur due to evaporation from the ejection port **201** not in the ejection operation to the collection flow path **1102**. Further, it is also possible to suppress the ink at the ejection port **201** from thickening. The liquid collected to the collection flow path **1102** is collected to the collection path of the main body of the liquid ejection apparatus. That is, in the present embodiment, the liquid circulates between the main body of the liquid ejection apparatus and the third liquid ejection head **1100**.

(93) Generally, in a case where ink circulation is performed, an ink including a solid component and whose density is high is ejected frequently. Because of this, generally, there is a trend for the pigment, emulsion and the like to increase. In that case, the agglomeration of the ink on a printing medium is more likely to change than the conventional ink, and therefore, there is a possibility that the nonuniformity due to the time difference is likely to become conspicuous in “non-link portion” and “link portion”.

(94) Then, accompanying the increase in the solid component, such as the pigment and emulsion, solidification of the ink on the ejection surface is likely to occur, and therefore, there is a case where a liquid that dissolves the sticking matter is attached at the time of a wipe or the like. Because of this, in the present embodiment also, it is preferable to arrange the end portion of the ejection element column and the terminal of the electrical connection portion so that they are distant from each other in the array direction. By increasing the distance from the front edge of the ejection element column to the terminal of the electrical connection portion in the array direction, more reliability is obtained.

(95) Consequently, even in a case where the liquid ejection head has the circulation function, the configuration is effective in which each electrical wiring member is arranged on the side further closer to the front edge in the array direction and extended to the outside of the long side of the liquid ejection head in the same direction. That is, according to the technique of the present disclosure, it is possible to provide an element substrate and a liquid ejection head that are compact and whose reliability is high.

Comparative Example

(96) In the following, in order to explain the effect of circulation in the present embodiment, explanation is given by showing a comparative example. Explanation of the configuration the same as or corresponding to the configuration in the present embodiment is omitted appropriately and different points are explained mainly.

(97) FIG. **14** is a diagram for explaining a sixth comparative example.

(98) In a liquid ejection head **1300** in the present comparative example, multicolored liquids are ejected from the one element substrate **104**.

(99) As shown in FIG. **14**, the liquid ejection head **1300** in the present comparative example comprises a supply flow path **1301**, a supply flow path **1302**, a supply flow path **1303**, and a supply flow path **1304**.

(100) Further, the liquid ejection head **1300** comprises a connection flow path **1305**, a connection flow path **1306**, a connection flow path **1307**, and a connection flow path **1308**. Furthermore, the liquid ejection head **1300** comprises a collection flow path **1311**, a collection flow path **1312**, a collection flow path **1313**, and a collection flow path **1314**. Still furthermore, the liquid ejection head **1300** comprises a connection flow path **1315**, a connection flow path **1316**, a connection flow path **1317**, and a connection flow path **1318**.

(101) For example, in a case where the yellow ink is ejected, the ink is supplied from the supply flow path **1301** to the element substrate **104** via the connection flow path **1305**. In a case where the magenta ink is ejected, the ink is supplied from the supply flow path **1302** to the element substrate **104** via the connection flow path **1306**. In a case where the cyan ink is ejected, the ink is supplied from the supply flow path **1303** to the element substrate **104** via the connection flow path **1307**. In a case where the black ink is ejected, the ink is supplied from the supply flow path **1304** to the element substrate **104** via the connection flow path **1308**.

(102) On the contrary, in a case where the yellow ink is collected, the ink is collected from the element substrate **104** to the collection flow path **1311** via the connection flow path **1315**. In a case where the magenta ink is collected, the ink is collected from the element substrate **104** to the collection flow path **1312** via the connection flow path **1316**. In a case where the cyan ink is collected, the ink is collected from the element substrate **104** to the collection flow path **1313** via the connection flow path **1317**. In a case where the black ink is collected, the ink is collected from the element substrate **104** to the collection flow path **1314** via the connection flow path **1318**.

(103) As explained above, in a case where the inks of the four colors are supplied to the one element substrate and collected from the one element substrate, the supply flow path and the collection flow path are required for each color of the inks, in addition to the increase in the opening area of each supply flow path and each collection flow path. Because of this, the width (here, the length in the short-side direction) of the liquid ejection head **1300** becomes very great. Then, the length of each connection flow path becomes longer and the shape of each connection flow path becomes complicated. Consequently, the influence of the pressure loss in the ink flowing within each connection flow path becomes large. Consequently, with the configuration such as this, it is made difficult to eject the ink whose viscosity is high and a large amount of ink.

(104) Further, even in a case where the element substrate is downsized, the density of the ejection ports in the ejection element column increases. Consequently, with the liquid ejection head having one element substrate ejecting multicolored inks and having the circulation function, it is made difficult to eject the ink whose viscosity is high and a large amount of ink because of the pressure loss of the liquid flowing within the connection path.

(105) From the above, by designing a configuration so that a one-color ink is ejected from one element substrate, it is made possible to implement downsizing of the element substrate and simplify the configuration of the connection flow path. That is, designing a configuration so that a one-color ink is ejected from one element substrate is effective.

Third Embodiment

(106) In the second embodiment, the liquid ejection head having the function to circulate a one-color ink is explained. Next, a liquid ejection head having a function to circulate liquids of two colors is explained as a third embodiment. In the following, explanation of the configuration the same as or corresponding to the configuration of the first embodiment and the second embodiment is omitted by using the same name and the same symbol and different points are explained mainly.

(107) FIG. **15** is a perspective diagram schematically showing one example of a liquid ejection head in the present embodiment.

(108) As shown in FIG. **15**, in a fourth liquid ejection head **1500** in the present embodiment, a plurality of the electrical wiring members **105** extends toward opposite directions (in the example shown in FIG. **15**, the $-Y$ -direction and the $+Y$ -direction) and this point is different from the first embodiment. Further, inside the fourth liquid ejection head **1500**, two types of liquid circulate and this point is also different from the first embodiment.

(109) FIG. **16** is a schematic top diagram of the fourth liquid ejection head **1500** in the present embodiment.

(110) As shown in FIG. **16**, on the top surface of the second flow path member **102**, the element substrate **104** in which a first ejection element column **1501** is arranged and the element substrate **104** in which a second ejection element column **1502** is arranged are arrayed in-line, the element

substrates **104** ejecting liquids whose types are different from each other. In the present embodiment, the electrical wiring member **105** electrically connected with the element substrate **104** having the first ejection element column **1501** extends toward the +Y-direction. In contrast to this, the electrical wiring member **105** electrically connected with the element substrate **104** having the second ejection element column **1502** extends toward the -Y-direction. That is, the electrical wiring members electrically connected to the electrical connection portions of the element substrates ejecting liquids whose colors are different from each other extend in the directions opposite to each other.

(111) FIG. **17** is a perspective diagram schematically showing a cross section of the fourth liquid ejection head **1500** in the present embodiment.

(112) As shown in FIG. **17**, in the first flow path member **101** in the fourth liquid ejection head **1500**, a first supply flow path **1601** through which the liquid flows in a case where the liquid is ejected is formed. Further, in the first flow path member **101** in the present embodiment, a second supply flow path **1603** through which the liquid flows is formed, whose type is different from that of the liquid flowing through the first supply flow path **1601**.

(113) On the contrary, in the first flow path member **101** in the fourth liquid ejection head **1500**, a first collection flow path **1602** is formed, through which the liquid flows in a case where the same type of liquid as that of the liquid flowing through the first supply flow path **1601** is collected. Similarly, in the first flow path member **101** in the fourth liquid ejection head **1500**, a second collection flow path **1604** is formed, through which the liquid flows in a case where the same type of liquid as that of the liquid flowing through the second supply flow path **1603** is collected. That is, in the flow path portion in the present embodiment, the second supply flow path **1603** that supplies the liquid whose type is different from that of the liquid flowing through the first supply flow path **1601** is formed.

(114) Then, the fourth liquid ejection head **1500** has a third element substrate in which the first ejection element column **1501** ejecting the liquid supplied from the second supply flow path **1603** is arranged and a second electrical connection member electrically connected to the third element substrate. Further, the third element substrate is arrayed along a predetermined direction (for example, the X-direction in FIG. **17**) and the second electrical connection member extends in the direction (the +Y-direction) opposite to the direction (the -Y-direction) in which the electrical connection member in which the second ejection element column **1502** is arranged extends. Furthermore, in the flow path portion in the present embodiment, the second collection flow path **1604** that collects the liquid that is not ejected from the third element substrate is formed.

(115) According to the configuration such as this, also in a case where two types of liquid circulate inside one liquid ejection head, it is possible to achieve both suppression of nonuniformity and downsizing of the element substrate. That is, according to the technique of the present disclosure, it is possible to provide an element substrate and a liquid ejection head that are compact and whose reliability is high.

OTHER EMBODIMENT

(116) It is also possible to combine the configurations of the first embodiment to the third embodiment described above with one another.

(117) In the first embodiment to the third embodiment, as an example of a liquid, ink is used, but the liquid does not need to be ink. For example, it may also be possible to use various printing liquids including a processing liquid or the like that is used for the purpose of improving the fixing property of ink in a printing medium, reducing gloss nonuniformity, and improving abrasion resistance.

(118) According to the technique of the present disclosure, it is possible to provide a liquid ejection head that is compact and whose reliability of the electrical connection portion is high.

(119) While the present invention has been described with reference to exemplary embodiments, it is to be understood that the invention is not limited to the disclosed exemplary embodiments. The

scope of the following claims is to be accorded the broadest interpretation so as to encompass all such modifications and equivalent structures and functions.

(120) This application claims the benefit of Japanese Patent Application No. 2022-124711, filed Aug. 4, 2022, which are hereby incorporated by reference herein in its entirety.

Claims

1. A liquid ejection head having a plurality of sets of element substrates in which a plurality of ejection elements ejecting a liquid of the same type is arrayed and a plurality of sets of electrical wiring members for supplying electric power to the element substrates, wherein each of the element substrates is arrayed in a second direction inclined with respect to a first direction in which the plurality of ejection elements is arrayed, and each of the electrical wiring members is connected to a terminal arranged at one end portion of a corresponding one of the element substrates and extends in a third direction intersecting the first direction and the second direction.
2. The liquid ejection head according to claim 1, wherein one of the element substrates and an adjacent one of the element substrates include an area in which both the one and the adjacent one of the element substrates overlap each other in the third direction, and the overlap area includes an area including the end portion of the one element substrate and in which an ejection element column arranged on the one element substrate and an ejection element column arranged on the adjacent element substrate overlap each other.
3. The liquid ejection head according to claim 2, wherein a distance in the third direction from an ejection element arranged at a front edge in the first direction of the one element substrate to an ejection element arranged at a proximal end in the first direction of the adjacent element substrate is 2.6 mm or less.
4. The liquid ejection head according to claim 1, wherein in a case in which the shape of each of the element substrates is a rectangle, the length of a short side is 1.5 mm or less.
5. The liquid ejection head according to claim 1, wherein the second direction is inclined about 7 degrees with respect to the first direction.
6. The liquid ejection head according to claim 1, further comprising: a flow path portion in which a supply flow path supplying a liquid to the element substrates is formed.
7. The liquid ejection head according to claim 6, wherein in the flow path portion, a collection flow path collecting a liquid not ejected from the element substrates is formed.
8. The liquid ejection head according to claim 7, wherein in the flow path portion, a second supply flow path supplying a liquid whose type is different from that of a liquid flowing through the supply flow path is formed, the liquid ejection head comprises: a plurality of sets of second element substrates in which a plurality of ejection elements ejecting a liquid supplied from the second supply flow path is arrayed; and a plurality of sets of second electrical connection members for supplying electric power to the second element substrates, each of the second element substrates is arrayed along the second direction, and each of the second electrical connection members is connected to a terminal arranged on the other end portion of a corresponding one of the second element substrates and extends in a fourth direction opposite to the third direction.
9. The liquid ejection head according to claim 8, wherein in the flow path portion, a second collection flow path collecting a liquid not ejected from the second element substrates is formed.
10. A liquid ejection apparatus comprising: a liquid ejection head having a plurality of sets of element substrates in which a plurality of ejection elements ejecting a liquid of the same type is arrayed and a plurality of sets of electrical wiring members for supplying electric power to the element substrates, wherein each of the element substrates is arrayed in a second direction inclined with respect to a first direction in which the plurality of ejection elements is arrayed and each of the electrical wiring members is connected to a terminal arranged at one end portion of a corresponding one of the element substrates and extends in a third direction intersecting the first

direction and the second direction; and a liquid supply unit for supplying a liquid to the liquid ejection head.

11. The liquid ejection apparatus according to claim 10, further comprising: a conveyance unit configured to convey a printing medium onto which ink lands.

12. An ejection module comprising: an element substrate in which a plurality of ejection elements ejecting a liquid of the same type is arrayed along a first direction; and an electrical wiring member for supplying electric power to the element substrate, wherein the electrical wiring member is connected to a terminal arranged at one end portion of the element substrate and extends in a second direction intersecting the first direction.
